MATTHEW BATCHELDOR

Strategic Partnerships | Commercial Growth | Go-to-Market

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PROFILE

Partnerships and commercial growth leader who builds lasting relationships between platforms, brands, agencies and creators. Joined Google as its first commercial hire in New Zealand and grew an industry portfolio from around US$2M to more than US$40M a year through executive joint business planning. Since then, co-founded a media agency, led operations for a social creative agency and developed partnerships and audience growth for Uchi Japan. Brings together commercial strategy, content, measurement and partner execution.

SELECTED RESULTS

- Google: Grew annual industry portfolio from around US$2M to more than US$40M, with around US$12M in incremental partnership revenue in 2018.
- Spark: Led executive joint business plan involving NZ$12M+ in annual investment and a 12-month YouTube Masthead agreement covering 60 homepage days.
- Uchi Japan: Helped grow YouTube presence to 117,000 subscribers, with 700+ videos and 6.7M+ views.
- Smart Media: Co-founded an agency whose transparent media buying model reduced reported client media costs by up to 40%.

CORE EXPERTISE

Strategic partnerships and partner ecosystems | Joint business planning | Enterprise business development | Go-to-market strategy | Sponsorships and channel partnerships | YouTube and creator growth | Measurement and analytics | C-suite engagement | Team leadership

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Partnerships Director | May 2025 - July 2026
Uchi Japan | Remote, independent contractor

- Worked with founder and CEO across sponsorships, commercial partnerships, content distribution and growth for Uchi Japan, Uchi Media and Uchi Snow.
- Helped build YouTube audience to 117,000 subscribers, connecting creative production and audience development to commercial goals.
- Jointly closed Hotel101 Niseko partnership package covering production, promotion, sponsorship and developer listings, with commission linked to sales of Happy Rooms.
- Brought together specialists across creative, editorial, data, AI and paid media; collaborated on original films and scripts, including I Love Niseko.

General Manager, Operations | June 2024 - May 2025
Watch This, New Zealand | Remote contract

- Built operating and commercial processes for a mobile-first social creative agency, leading a five-person remote team with four direct reports.
- Introduced YouTube and branded entertainment into the agency offering alongside social production and paid distribution.

Co-Founder, Director & Managing Partner | March 2021 - July 2023
Smart Media Agency, New Zealand

- Co-founded agency and led new business, commercial strategy and client relationships, including accounts with NZ$500K to NZ$5M media budgets.
- Built accreditation and commercial relationships across programmatic, search, social and YouTube.
- Introduced transparent media buying model with reported client cost savings of up to 40%; managed four to five direct reports and 15 contract specialists.

Strategy Director & Business Development | August 2019 - July 2020
Momentum Media (formerly Point Media), New Zealand

- Led business development and media strategy, contributing to a tripling of agency media billings.
- Led AA Money client relationship and commercial media strategy, coordinating specialist colleagues on acquisition planning and cross-channel execution.

GOOGLE | AUCKLAND AND LONDON

Industry Head, Technology, Telecommunications, FMCG & Energy | October 2012 - October 2018
Large Customer Sales

- Grew annual industry portfolio from around US$2M to more than US$40M through executive relationships, joint business plans and go-to-market initiatives.
- Led Spark executive joint business plan involving NZ$12M+ a year across Search, YouTube, Display and Programmatic; signed a 12-month YouTube Masthead agreement covering 60 homepage days.
- Grew Xero account from around US$500K to US$3M in 12 months, working with senior global and country marketing leaders.
- Advanced Google Analytics 360 adoption in telecommunications and energy accounts, from business case to implementation.

Agency Team Lead | October 2008 - October 2012

- Led relationships with major global agency holding groups in New Zealand across measurement, mobile, video and customer acquisition.
- Represented Google on the IAB New Zealand Council, supporting measurement standards and industry education.

Key Account Manager - New Zealand | May 2007 - October 2008

- First commercial hire for Google in New Zealand, opening the market through advertiser development and winning early national travel and tourism accounts.

Key Account Manager - United Kingdom | April 2004 - April 2007

- Managed key London advertiser accounts and participated in product testing after Google acquired Urchin, the platform that became Google Analytics.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Technical Marketing Manager | December 2002 - November 2003
The Cloud, London

- Managed BT Openzone technical deployment across 118 locations and a £2M marketing budget during early public Wi-Fi rollout.

Travel Category Manager / Customer Champion Lead / Complaints Coordinator | November 1999 - November 2002
lastminute.com, London

- Held three roles during the early growth of online travel and e-commerce.

RECOGNITION

- Google Industry Gold Award, Samsung video effectiveness
- Google Innovation Award, Xero live growth dashboard
- NZDMA Gold Award, Vodafone “Say It Tika”
- Two Silver Beacon Awards, Genesis Energy

EDUCATION

BA (Hons), Biblical Studies | The University of Sheffield

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

UK Citizen and Spanish Resident | Native English | Valencia, Spain | Open to remote EMEA roles and international travel